



YOUSSEF AL ZANOUN Associated Press

GAZAN authorities estimate Israeli strikes have left more than 8,500 bodies buried under 61.5 million tons of rubble. In Gaza City, a funeral is held at a mosque Wednesday for a Palestinian aid official killed in a strike. **A5**

UKRAINE TO GET LICENSE TO MAKE PATRIOTS

Trump announces the U.S. will allow foreign manufacture of system for missile air defense.

By LORNE COOK, SEUNG MIN KIM AND SUZAN FRASER

ANKARA, Turkey — President Trump said at a NATO summit Wednesday in Turkey that the U.S. will give Ukraine a license to make Patriot air defense systems to counter missile attacks from Russia in their more than four-year war, a huge coup for Kyiv, which has long requested the technology.

Allowing foreign manufacture of Patriots, which the U.S. had resisted, was a turnaround for Trump that mirrored his day at the NATO meeting: Upon arriving, he lashed out at European partners for resisting his efforts to take control of Greenland and for not supporting his war in Iran. But by day's end, he described a gathering of unity and "tremendous love," and praised member nations on their progress in increasing their defense spending.

NATO's European members plus Canada have scrambled to meet the alliance's increased defense spending targets, which Trump has demanded as the U.S. draws down troops in Europe and insists the continent take more responsibility for its own security.

Trump had reopened old wounds among the 32 NATO leaders by insisting again ahead of the summit that the U.S. should control Greenland, a semiautonomous Danish territory. That led Denmark's Prime Minister to say the U.S. was "oversteering." [See Patriots, A4]

A Gaza father's dire search for a dead son

Thousands of bodies are trapped under rubble

By Bilal Shbeir and Nabih Bulos

GAZA CITY — Yusef al-Zaharnah's eyes were transfixed on the excavator's bucket as its claws scooped into the rubble, hoping its fresh load would end nine grueling months of uncertainty and allow him to fully grieve.

Once it disgorged its haul, Al-Zaharnah, a burly, weary-looking 56-year-old, climbed over the detritus and bent low for a closer look. But his search yielded only crushed masonry; no bones, and no sign of his son, or the others killed with him.

"If I see even a small piece, whether it belongs to my son or to someone else's, at least they can finally be buried," Al-Zaharnah said, trudging back to his spot by the excavator to await the next load and resume his search.

Al-Zaharnah's journey of mourning began in October when an Israeli missile leveled the five-story building in Gaza City where his family was sheltering with others during Israel's war against Hamas militants.

More than 40 people were killed in the airstrike, including three of his sons: Munther, 31; Mutaz, 26; and 21-year-old Abdul Karim.

He had managed to pull out the bodies of Munther and Abdul Karim in the first days after the airstrike and buried them beside another son, Munir, 28, who died in an Israeli strike in June 2025.

But Mutaz remained missing, his body impossible to reach without heavy machinery that [See Gaza, A4]



SCOTT SADY For The Times

THE CALDOR FIRE of 2021 left a burn scar behind Reid Reichardt's home.

Herbicide plan spurs concern

Is glyphosate worth the risk? Two forest communities differ

By NOAH HAGGERTY

SOUTH LAKE TAHOE, Calif. — For years, Reid Reichardt walked the forest trails behind his Lake Tahoe Basin cabin nearly every day with his dog Jasmine. Then in 2021, the Caldor fire swept through, incinerating it all.

"It was really a sense of mourning and grief to lose this," Reichardt said, eyes fixed on the towering black-

ened sticks around him.

Since then, Reichardt has watched birds, flowers, a sea of green shrubs and baby conifers fill in the moonscape. It's been a ray of hope for him.

But two months ago, Reichardt got a text from a friend: The U.S. Forest Service had approved a plan to kill off shrubs it says are blocking the conifers from growing. It plans to use glyphosate, an herbicide

California has determined causes cancer.

"I think many people, including me, would say, I'd rather my house burn down than get cancer," he said.

Increasingly severe wildfires — fueled by climate change and more than a century of forest mismanagement — have forced an environmental reckoning on mountain towns nestled in California's Sierra Nevada. [See Forests, A7]

Trump calls Iran ceasefire 'over,' orders strikes

The escalation marks a sharp reversal after weeks of talking up a deal with Tehran.

By NABIH BULOS AND ANA CEBALLOS

WASHINGTON — A tentative armistice between the United States and Iran reached less than a month ago appeared all but dead Wednesday after the two sides traded fresh military strikes, and as President Trump directed further attacks on the Islamic Republic.

The escalation marked a dramatic turn after the Trump administration spent weeks selling a diplomatic breakthrough with Tehran that proved controversial across the political aisle, lifting oil sanctions and a naval blockade on Iran in exchange for the promise of talks over the status of the Strait of Hormuz and its decades-old nuclear program.

Now, speaking to reporters at the NATO summit in Turkey, Trump said he believed the truce — which diplomats describe as a memorandum of understanding — was "over" and that it was a "waste of time" dealing with Iranian leadership.

"They're scum. They're sick people," Trump said of

Iranian leaders, whom he had characterized last month as "very rational people" and "very nice to deal with."

The president's dim views of the ceasefire agreement's fate were shared by Iran's foreign ministry, which issued a statement on Wednesday saying the American attacks, the reinstatement of a U.S. naval blockade on the Strait of Hormuz, and Israel's continuing attacks in Lebanon rendered "important and fundamental" parts of the deal "ineffective."

The truce's unraveling was underscored by Trump's ordering the U.S. military to launch a series of strikes against Iran on Wednesday afternoon to "further degrade their ability to threaten" the commercial shipping through the Strait of Hormuz.

"The United States is holding Iran accountable for recent unjustified aggression against commercial shipping and civilian crews freely navigating a vital international waterway," U.S. Central Command said in a statement on social media.

Earlier in the day, Trump signaled that the United States planned to "hit them hard" and floated the possibility of taking over Kharg Island, which is vital to Iran's economy. His remarks quickly prompted oil prices [See Iran, A5]

UC renews debate over using SATs

Standardized tests ended 6 years ago. Ex-leader Napolitano supports a review.

By JAWEED KALEEM

The debate over whether the University of California should restore the SAT in admissions, expected to surface next week before regents, is emerging as one of its most closely watched and consequential issues as leaders assess how the nation's premier public university decides who gets a coveted seat.

There are early signs that views may have changed in the six years since the governing board unanimously voted to eliminate SAT and ACT requirements. One of the most significant: Former UC President Janet Napolitano, who was at UC's helm at the time, says a hard reassessment is much needed after a faculty outcry that students are severely deficient in math skills.

A standardized test score "shouldn't be a sole factor" in determining access to UC, Napolitano said, but a renewed look at admissions could conclude it should be "a factor."

She and others spoke to the high stakes of the decision amid a supercharged political climate in which the

Trump administration has opened multiple investigations into UC admission practices for alleged racial discrimination.

"It's been a six-year experiment, and it now needs to be revisited," Napolitano said in an interview with The Times. The former president, who successfully pushed to end the requirement in 2020, said the racial and class equity logic that drove that decision deserves a second look. "It's not like the SAT erases those inequities, but it's not like the SAT adds to those inequities."

UC leaders have shown a distinct willingness to take on the issue amid changes at the highest echelon of university decision-makers since 2020. A new UC president, James Milliken, took over a year ago. The Board of Regents has turned over substantially, with newer appointees now in the majority. Five of UC's nine undergraduate campuses also have new chancellors.

The debate comes as UC increasingly stands as a national outlier in its refusal to consider SAT and ACT scores. A growing number of prestigious universities — including Stanford, Harvard and Yale — and public university systems in Tennessee, Georgia and Texas have reinstated testing made optional during the COVID-19 pandemic. Others, including [See SAT, A7]

Big changes at a small airport

Hollywood Burbank plans to open its \$1.3-billion, roomier terminal in October.

By CHRISTOPHER REYNOLDS

While uncertainty lingers over improvements and timetables at LAX, the county's second-busiest airport is on the brink of big changes.

The Hollywood Burbank Airport is due to replace its two terminals with a larger new terminal on Oct. 13. The \$1.3-billion project will in-

clude 14 gates — the same number the airport has now. But the new structure will be a single terminal that's about 50% larger than the airport's current two-terminal layout.

In moving to a 355,000-square-foot terminal, officials say, the airport can give passengers more room and better technology while meeting safety and accessibility standards.

The airport, built in 1930 and run by the Burbank-Glendale-Pasadena Airport Authority, is favored by many local travelers as a simpler, faster alternative to Los Angeles International Airport. The Burbank air-

port's site in the San Fernando Valley, however, has often put its leaders at odds with residents of surrounding suburban neighborhoods.

As it stands, the aged Burbank facility doesn't meet current state seismic standards or Federal Aviation Administration design standards — which has prompted repeated safety warnings. Its nine resident airlines fly to about 30 non-stop destinations. The airport reported about 6.2 million arriving and departing passengers in 2025.

Airport officials say the new design increases the [See Airport, A11]



Netflix

EMMY SURPRISES

"Beef's" 16 noms include Carey Mulligan, center, and Charles Melton, but not Cailee Spaeny, left. That's a snub, our writer says. **ENTERTAINMENT, E1**

Subsidies expand for child care

Newsom will achieve nearly three-quarters of slots he promised with the plan. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

StubHub is sued over World Cup

California fans allege firm failed to deliver on tickets in possible class-action suit. **BUSINESS, A9**

Weather
Sunny and warm.
L.A. Basin: 86/64. **B6**

Markets **A11**
Opinion Voices **A12**



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